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Culture (OWC): [Luguru \(FN32\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

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Coverage Date: 1945 AD - 1959 AD

Place Coverage

Uluguru Mountains, Morogoro Region, Tanzania

Section Title(S): The Clan

The clan

In addition to tribe and local community, with its subunits, the Luguru are differentiated by clan and lineage. There are over fifty known Luguru clans. (See Appendix II.) A clan, called in Luguru *lukoro* or in Swahili *ukoo*, is the widest acknowledged group tracing descent (putative or real) through the female line and possessing a common name, which is inherited matrilineally. The clan is an exogamous unit and is not necessarily limited tribally to the Luguru, inasmuch as some clans extend to neighboring tribes and so control to some degree inter-tribal marriage. The rights and duties of clanship, as distinct from lineage membership, can be quickly summarized. In the first place, the clan forms the exogamous unit. Even where two maximal lineages, sharing a common name, claim to have arrived in Luguru independently, their members cannot intermarry. At times the rules of exogamy exceed the clan limits; there are certain clans, for instance Kinoge and Maze, between which intermarriage is forbidden. In one case this is attributed to an alleged close relationship in the country of origin; in another, to a recent embargo imposed by one of the emergent political leaders, Mbago.

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The clans are not totemic, nor do they possess a common tabu or prohibition. Such prohibitions *do* exist in Luguru, but they are inherited from one's father and do not play a major part in the social system. A more important relationship between clans is that of *ugongo* (L.) or *utani* (S.), i.e. reciprocal or joking relationship. Not all clans possess a link in this manner, but where they do there is also a trend to preferential marriage between the two linked clans. Sometimes three clans may be linked in triangular formation. The chief manifestation of the relationship is in the matter of burial, where the members

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of the deceased's reciprocating clan can hold **45** up proceedings by going into the grave and refusing to come out until paid to do so.

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